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OCTOBER 20, 1959
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GG–R–00791c(GSA–FSS)
August 17, 1959 and
Fed. Spec. GG–R–791a
March 14, 1941

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

RULER, WOOD, (DESK)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—The wood, desk rulers covered by this specification are for general office use.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types.*—Rulers shall be of the following types, as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.1):

Type I. —With brass-coated steel edgings on both sides of ruler and with brass ends.

Type II. —With brass-coated steel edging on one side of ruler and with brass ends.

Type III.—With brass-coated steel edging on one side of ruler, without brass ends.

Type IV.—Without brass-coated steel edging or brass ends.

1.2.2 *Sizes (lengths).*—(See 3.2.)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

PPP–B–566 — Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.

PPP–B–636—Boxes, Fiber.

PPP–B–665—Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).

PPP–B–676 — Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

PPP–T–97 — Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

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and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL–L–10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL–STD–129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.—Types I, II, and III rulers shall be made from selected hard maple; type IV rulers shall be of suitable hardwood meeting the requirements of this specification. Wood shall be well-seasoned stock free from imperfections such as chips, dents and flaws, and chipouts, which mar the appearance or which might impair the serviceability of the rulers. Characteristics common to wood such as mineral specks, burls, tight knots not exceeding ¼ inch in diameter, and birdseye will be permitted.

3.2 Dimensions and tolerances. — Dimensions and tolerances of the rulers shall be as specified in table I and in 3.2.1 and 3.2.2. Sizes (lengths) of rulers shall be furnished as specified in the invitation for bids, contract, or order, except that type IV rulers shall be furnished in 12-inch length only as shown in table I.

3.2.1 The ruler shall lie flat within the same requirements as those for permissible departure from the straightedge specified above.

3.2.2 The accuracy of the positions of the zero graduation and the graduation at the extreme length with respect to their respective ends of the ruler shall fall within a tolerance of plus or minus 1/64 inch.

TABLE I.—*Dimensions and tolerances*

Types	Lengths (sizes) [1, 2]	Width		Thickness, min.
		Min.	Max.	
	Inches	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inch*
I, II, and III	12 15 18 24	1¼	1½	¼
IV	12	⅞	--	5/32

[1] A tolerance of plus or minus 1/32 inch will be permitted in the overall length.

[2] Permissible departure from a straightedge measured at point of maximum departure shall be plus or minus 1/32 inch for 12- and 15-inch rulers and plus or minus 1/16 inch for 18- and 24-inch rulers (see *Note*).

Note.—Permissible departure from the straightedge refers to the distance between two lines parallel to the length of the ruler, one line touching points on the edge of the ruler of maximum bulge, the other line touching points on the edge where there is a maximum depression.

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3.3 Graduations.—Types I, II, and III rulers shall be scaled in black in inches and sixteenth inch. A different length of scaling shall be used to indicate each individual fraction of an inch, i.e., 1/16, 1/8, 1/4, and 1/2. Each inch shall be indicated by a figure denoting its length from the zero graduation. Graduations for type IV rulers shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, contract, or order (see 6.1).

3.4 Ends and edgings.

3.4.1 *Type I.*—Type I rulers shall be equipped with brass ends not less than 0.035 inch in thickness, completely covering the wood ends of the ruler; and with brass-coated steel edgings at least 3/32 inch wide and not less than 0.011 inch thick inserted in both edges. Both ends and edgings shall be securely fastened in place. The edgings shall be anchored in suitable slots in the brass ends for a distance of not less than one-half the thickness of the brass end. The metal edging shall not project beyond the body of the ruler at either end.

3.4.2 *Type II.*—Type II rulers shall be as specified in 3.4.1 except that the rulers shall have one beveled edge with a brass-coated steel edging.

3.4.3 *Type III.*—Type III rulers shall be as specified in 3.4.1 except that the rulers shall have one beveled edge provided with a brass-coated steel edging, and brass ends are not required. A minus tolerance of 1/16 inch in the length of the edging will be permitted.

3.4.4 *Type IV.*—Type IV rulers do not require brass ends or metal edgings.

3.5 Finish.—Types I, II, and III rulers shall have at least two coats of clear, hard-drying varnish which shows the grain of the wood. A slight tinting (light oak) of the varnish will be acceptable provided the grain of the wood is not obscured or made cloudy. Type IV rulers shall be as specified herein except that one coat of varnish will be acceptable. All surfaces shall have a smooth and uniform finish. The edges shall be true and the graduations clearly and accurately marked.

3.6 Identification marking.—Unless otherwise specified, identification product marking shall be in accordance with standard commercial practice.

3.7 Workmanship.—Workmanship shall be in accordance with standard commercial practice and there shall be no defects which might impair the serviceability of the commodity.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Unless otherwise specified herein, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to submission for Government inspection and acceptance. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order.

4.2 Lot.—All rulers of the same type and size offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of sampling for examination and tests.

4.3 Sampling.

4.3.1 *For visual and dimensional examination.*—Random samples of rulers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105. Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall not exceed 2.5 percent defective.

4.3.2 *For tests.*—Random samples of rulers shall be taken from the lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105, Inspection Level L–3.

4.4 Examination.—Samples taken in accordance with 4.3.1 shall be examined to determine conformance with the requirements

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for material, dimensions, construction of ends and edgings, permanency of fastening of the brass ends and brass-coated steel edgings (types I, II, and III rulers, as applicable), finish and workmanship, packaging and any other requirements not covered by tests.

4.5 **Tests.**—The accuracy of the graduations, length, and the departure from a straightedge shall be determined by comparison with a straightedge or scale of recognized accuracy. In accordance with the note to table I, the requirements of 3.2 and 3.2.2 shall be determined with the ruler held against the testing surface, either at approximately the center or simultaneously at both ends. The ruler shall not be held at one end only when determining conformity to 3.2 and 3.2.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 **Federal Standard No. 102 (for civil agencies only).** — Levels of preservation, packaging, and packing protection shall be as defined in Federal Standard No. 102.

5.2 **Packaging.**—(See 6.1.)

5.2.1 *Level A.* — Twelve rulers shall be packaged in a folding carton or set-up box conforming to Federal Specifications PPP–B–566 and PPP–B–665, respectively. Box closure shall conform to the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 *Level B (civil agencies).* — Twelve rulers of the same type and size shall be packaged in a box conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–676, type I or II, or Federal Specification PPP–B–566, style II, type A, class a. Closure shall be in accordance with the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.*—Unless otherwise specified, rulers shall be packaged in accordance with manufacturer's standard commercial practice.

5.3 **Packing.**—(See 6.1.)

5.3.1 *Quantity per shipping container (military agencies).*—The quantity of rulers per shipping container shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.1). In the absence of specified quantities, the weight limitations in 5.3.2 and 5.3.3 shall apply.

5.3.2 *Level A (military agencies).*—Rulers shall be packed in overseas-type fiberboard boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–636, class 2, V3c or V3s. Gross weight of boxes shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Boxes shall be furnished with case liners conforming to Military Specification MIL–L–10547, sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto. Box closure and strapping shall conform to the appendix to the box specification. In lieu of steel strapping, boxes shall be reinforced with pressure-sensitive filament tape conforming to type IV of Federal Specification PPP–T–97, applied in accordance with the Appendix thereto.

5.3.3 *Level B.*

5.3.3.1 *Military agencies.*—Rulers, packaged as specified in 5.2.1, shall be packed in domestic-type fiberboard boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–636, class 1; minimum bursting strength not less than 200 p.s.i. Gross weight limitations and box closures shall conform to the box specification and the Appendix thereto.

5.3.3.2 *Civil agencies.*—Thirty-six boxes (5.2.2) of twelve rulers each (432 units) shall be packed in a shipping container conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification PPP–B–636, type I or II, class 1 (domestic service), Style RSC. Bursting strength of fiberboard used in the box construction shall be not less than 200 p.s.i. Closure shall be in accordance with PPP–B–636.

5.3.4 *Level C.*—Unless otherwise specified, the subject commodity shall be packed in standard commercial containers so constructed as to comply with the carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

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5.4 **Marking.**—(See 6.1.)

5.4.1 *Civil agencies.*

5.4.1.1 *Packages.* — Packages shall be marked or labeled on one end, in addition to any commercial marking or any special marking specified in the contract or order, with the applicable Federal Stock Number, nomenclature, type and size of ruler, quantity contained therein (12-each), contract or order number, and name of the contractor.

5.4.1.2 *Shipping containers.*—In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123.

5.4.2 *Military agencies.*—In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.**—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein (see 3.6, 4.1, 5.2.3, and 5.3.4) and should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type of ruler required (see 1.2.1).
(*c*) Size (length) of ruler required for types I, II and III (see 1.2.2).
(*d*) Graduations required for type IV ruler (see 3.3).
(*e*) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.2 and 5.3).
(*f*) Quantity of rulers per shipping container, for military shipments, (see 5.3.1).
(*g*) Any special marking for shipment required (see 5.4).

6.2 This specification covers only the types and lengths of the commodity as generally purchased by the Federal Government, and is not intended to include all of the types, etc., which are commercially available.

6.3 **Transportation description.**—Transportation description and minimum weight applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:
Rulers or rules, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:
Rulers, wooden, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, National Motor Freight Classification.

6.4 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTEREST:
Army—Quartermaster Corps
Navy—Bureau of Supplies and Accounts
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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